

Flooding

ACTION CHECKLIST

Move to higher ground if water is rising or a flash-flood warning affects you. Never walk, swim, or drive through floodwater; depth, current, contamination, and road damage are hard to judge. Follow evacuation orders and avoid basements or low areas that can fill rapidly.

[] Get above the water

Leave low ground and move to a safe higher location. If a road is flooded, turn around and choose another route.

[] Read the local notice

Check alerts, road closures, and evacuation instructions. Do not rely on the road being open because it was open earlier.

[] Keep away from hazards

Floodwater may hide energized wires, debris, sewage, chemicals, and missing road surface. Keep children and pets away.

[] If trapped, call for help

Give your precise location to emergency services. Move to a higher level if possible; avoid entering a closed attic where you could become trapped by rising water.

WATCH FOR

Flooding can begin far from the heaviest rain. Do not attempt to cross flowing water to reach a vehicle, home, or belongings.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/flooding/>

Ready.gov · Floods

CDC · Floodwater safety